## 6.22 Ascites and Paracentesis*

| Assessment | Nursing Diagnosis | Plan / Expected Outcome | Nursing Interventions | Evaluation |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Subjective**<br>• "I cannot breathe well with this big belly."<br>**Objective**<br>• Tense ascites<br>• RR 26/min<br>• Using accessory muscles | **ACTUAL**<br>Ineffective breathing pattern related to pressure of ascites on the diaphragm as evidenced by dyspnea and tachypnea. | • Breathing easier after paracentesis. | • Sit him semi-Fowler.<br>• Ask him to pass urine before the procedure.<br>• Record baseline vital signs and weight.<br>• Note the volume and appearance of fluid removed.<br>• Give albumin after large-volume drainage, as ordered. | • Achieved when breathing is easier. |
| **Subjective**<br>• "My abdomen feels heavy and tight."<br>**Objective**<br>• Distended abdomen<br>• Keeps changing position | **ACTUAL**<br>Impaired physical comfort related to abdominal distension as evidenced by reported discomfort. | • Feels more comfortable. | • Support him with pillows.<br>• Provide loose clothing.<br>• Give analgesia if prescribed. | • Outcome reached when he is comfortable. |
| **Subjective**<br>*No specific complaint*<br>**Objective**<br>• Large-volume paracentesis | **RISK**<br>Risk for inadequate fluid volume as evidenced by risk factors: rapid fluid shift after drainage. | • BP stable after the procedure. | • Watch BP and HR during and after drainage.<br>• Check the puncture site for leakage.<br>• Weigh him the next day. | • Considered met if vital signs stay stable. |

* **References for this care plan:** [32], [35], [37], [75]. Full entries are listed in the References section of the CPMN book.